

LIVING LEARNING CONTRACT

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Thesis/ Project Focus

Create an ongoing, wireframe web-based game for CART 415 by exploring how a large team can collaboratively develop a simple asynchronous multiplayer experience within a limited production timeline.

The project will focus on researching, designing, and prototyping a multiplayer, multi-device game that can realistically be developed, while identifying potential challenges in coordinating a strong collective effort.

Thesis/ Project Outcome

Deliver a functional and presentation-ready wireframe/prototype of an ongoing asynchronous multiplayer game to the students in the Winter term, along with the design decisions, gameplay structure, and identified challenges that can support continued development.

Knowledge Base / Fields/ Domains/ Keywords

Simple, Asynchronous, Multiplayer, Persistent, Player interaction, Collective game development, Large-team collaboration

Link to my day-to-day Workbook:

<https://app.fizzy.do/6280768/boards/03gvktp70q0si62plu6cacelo>

Learning Objectives

1. **Prototype an asynchronous multiplayer game that provides a clear and engaging user experience.**

Explore how simple, persistent, and asynchronous interactions can encourage cooperation between players who may not be playing at the same time. Develop and iterate on wireframes and prototypes to communicate the core gameplay loop, player interactions, interface, and overall user experience.

2. **Research, evaluate, and solve design challenges throughout the prototyping process.**

Investigate existing asynchronous, multiplayer, cooperative, and persistent

games to understand different design approaches. Identify potential gameplay, UX, technical, and production risks in proposed concepts, then develop and test possible solutions. Use this process to create reusable design approaches or templates that can support future development.

3. Develop professional communication and collaboration skills through a real-client project.

Practice communicating with the client by presenting concepts and prototypes, asking relevant questions, understanding requirements, documenting feedback, and incorporating client input into design decisions. Learn to balance the team's creative ideas with the client's needs, project constraints, and feedback throughout the development process.

4. Manage a collaborative game project through clear task distribution and coordinated production.

Develop an organized workflow for a large team by dividing responsibilities according to members' roles and strengths, establishing measurable deliverables, tracking progress, and maintaining communication between different areas of the project. Learn how to keep individual contributions aligned toward one shared game concept and manage the project within the available timeline and scope.

Learning Activities

- **Learning Activity Outcome #1: Researching game examples to use as references**
 - Collect interesting mechanics, UX ideas, and examples that could inspire our project.
- **Learning Activity Outcome #2: Game Ideation & Concept Development**
 - Discuss and compare the concepts as a team, considering gameplay, asynchronous interaction, cooperation, user experience, technical feasibility, and the 10-week production scope.
- **Learning Activity Outcome #3: Risk Analysis & Rapid Prototyping**
 - For each candidate concept, identify potential UX, gameplay, technical, and production risks. Create low-fidelity prototypes using paper sketches, flowcharts, wireframes, or interactive prototypes to test the core gameplay loop and player interactions. Iterate based on team feedback.
- **Learning Activity Outcome #4: Client Communication & Feedback**
 - Mark down client feedback, clarify requirements through questions, and use the feedback to select and refine the final concept.
- **Learning Activity Outcome #5: Documentation & Winter-Term Handoff**
 - Document the final game concept, gameplay flow, design decisions, identified issues, proposed solutions, and future development recommendations.

MILESTONES

Milestone #1: Internal Pitch & Downselection

Team members pitch individual ideas to narrow down to three candidate concepts. The team will research existing asynchronous multiplayer games, discuss the feasibility and risks of each idea, and create initial sketches or wireframes to communicate the core gameplay. By the end of this milestone, three concepts will be selected for further prototyping.

Milestone #2: Client Prototype Pitch

Build rapid prototypes for all three concepts, demonstrate them to the client, and lock in the final game idea. The team will develop the main gameplay flow and player interactions for each concept, test the prototypes internally, and collect feedback from the client. The outcome will be one selected concept with a clearer direction for its gameplay, user experience, and asynchronous interactions.

Milestone #3: Production & Final Presentation

Expand and polish the selected concept into a presentation-ready prototype for the CART415 class next semester. The team will develop the wireframes and core interactions, test and refine the prototype, address key design issues, and organize the final documentation. The completed prototype and documentation will provide a clear foundation for the Winter-term students to continue developing the game.

WEEKLY PLAN

WEEK/ WEEK OF	PLAN	DETAIL (Make sure these are measurable and quantifiable)	WORK DUE (#Reflection due every week)
September 23	1st Client Meeting	Meet with Jonathan, clarify project requirements, expectations, constraints, and questions about the project	Learning Activity Outcome #4
September 30	Ideation (coming up with ideas and narrowing it)	Each member develops 3 to 5 game ideas and presents them to the team	Living Learning Contract + Initial Idea List
October 7	Risks and approaches to the ideas	Members approach each idea. Identify the risks and strategies. (answer, visuals, game display, controls...)	Milestone #1
October 14	Risks and approaches, plus adding visual prototypes	Filter with the idea and start to finalize each concept; start building the visual prototype	Learning Activity Outcome #3
October 21	Prototype idea (presentation building)	Finalize pitch ideas and build presentation	Prototype Presentation
October 28	Midterm Client Meeting	Present 3 concepts to the client, collect feedback, discuss feasibility, and determine which concept should move forward (Make a 3-slide PowerPoint for each idea)	Milestone #2
November 4	Take Jonathan's feedback and work on the selected idea (or concept)	Document Jonathan's feedback and identify the main changes,	Learning Activity Outcome #4

WEEK/ WEEK OF	PLAN	DETAIL (Make sure these are measurable and quantifiable)	WORK DUE (#Reflection due every week)
		priorities, and approaches needed for the selected concept	
November 11	Refining concepts/ideas	Develop the selected concept by completing assigned team tasks	Individual Assigned work
November 18	Refining concepts and building visual prototype	Work on building and connecting the main wireframes, visual elements, and interaction flows for the selected concept.	Prototype Development
November 25	Finalizing visual prototypes and creating presentation	Prepare the final presentation	Learning Activity Outcome #5
December 2	Final Presentation	Presenting final pitch	Milestone #3